

PATTERN

Granny Square Market Bag Pattern

Nine granny squares, joined and folded into a sturdy everyday tote — a great scrap-yarn project.

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This bag is built from nine identical granny squares arranged in a 3×3 grid, then folded and seamed into a box shape with a flat crocheted strap. If you haven't made a granny square before, our [granny square tutorial](#) covers the stitch-by-stitch basics first.

What you need

- Worsted/#4 weight yarn, ideally cotton or a cotton blend for structure, in 2–3 colors
- 4.5mm hook
- Yarn needle
- Stitch markers

Step 1: make nine granny squares

Following our [granny square tutorial](#), make nine identical squares, each worked to 4 rounds. Keep every square the same size, and weave in ends as you finish each one to save time later.

Step 2: lay out and join

Steps

1. Arrange your nine squares in a 3×3 grid, right side up, alternating colors if you like.
2. Join the squares in each row of three first, working slip-stitch or whip-stitch seams along the touching edges.
3. Join the three rows together the same way to form one 3×3 panel.

Step 3: fold into a bag shape

Steps

1. Fold the joined panel so the bottom row becomes the base, and the two side columns fold up to become the sides — the top row stays open as the bag's opening.
2. Seam the two side edges closed, working from the base up to the top edge.

Step 4: add the strap and edging

Steps

1. Join yarn at one top corner and single crochet evenly around the entire top opening for one round, to neaten the edge.

2. For the strap, chain a length of about 90cm (adjust to your preference), then single crochet back across the chain for 3–4 rows to build a sturdy flat strap.
3. Sew one end of the strap to each side of the bag's top edge, checking it isn't twisted before securing.

Optional: lining

Granny squares have natural gaps between stitches, so a fabric lining sewn in by hand will keep small items from slipping through — cut a rectangle to match your bag's folded dimensions plus a small seam allowance.

Frequently asked questions

What yarn works best for a market bag?

Cotton or a cotton blend holds its shape and washes well; wool alone tends to stretch under the weight of groceries.

Do I need to line it?

Not required, but recommended if you plan to carry small or loose items, since granny squares have open gaps.

Can I make it bigger?

Yes — use a 4×4 grid of squares instead of 3×3, or work more rounds per square to make each one larger.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.